

Does Treatment Affect Outcome?

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Template demo

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Motivation

Motivation

- A first-order question in the field is still open: *does treatment T shift outcome Y ?*
- Prior work is suggestive, but **identification is contested**.
- This talk lays out a clean design that addresses the main threats.

Research question

Does T have a causal effect on Y , and through which channel?

Design

Data and identification

- **Sample:** an illustrative panel (template-demo data).
- **Strategy:** two-way fixed effects with a placebo check.

$$Y_{i,t} = \beta T_{i,t} + \mathbf{X}'_{i,t}\gamma + \alpha_i + \delta_t + \varepsilon_{i,t}$$

- Coefficient of interest: β . Prediction: $\beta \neq 0$.
- Standard errors clustered at the unit level.

Results

Main result (illustrative)

	(1)	(2)
T	-0.12 (0.03)	-0.09 (0.03)
Controls	No	Yes
Unit / time FE	Yes	Yes

Takeaway

The estimate is stable across specifications and economically meaningful.

Illustrative numbers — generated template demo, not real data.

Conclusion

Conclusion

- A clean design delivers a credible estimate of β .
- Robust to the main identification threats (placebo, FE escalation).
- Next steps: mechanism evidence and external validity.

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